

**ETHIOPIAN SECONDARY SCHOOL LEAVING CERTIFICATE EXAMINATIONS
(ESSLCE)**

2018 Online english exam (simulated)

BOOKLET CODE: 01 SUBJECT CODE: 01

Time Allowed: 2:00 HOURS

**GENERAL DIRECTIONS: THIS BOOKLET CONTAINS 100 MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS.
CAREFULLY SELECT THE BEST ANSWER. DO NOT COPY OR CHEAT.**

I. Writing (1-17).

Directions: The following questions are related to different aspects of writing. Read each very carefully and choose the best answer.

SECTION ONE: Paragraph Coherence (1-3)

Directions: Choose the letter that represents the best arrangement of the sentences to get a coherent paragraph.

- 1.
- a. Art is a universal expression of human emotion and creativity.
 - b. Furthermore, it connects people across different cultures and eras.
 - c. It takes many forms, such as painting, music, and literature.
 - d. For instance, a simple painting can evoke deep feelings in a viewer.

- A. a c d b
- B. a d c b
- C. c a b d
- D. b c d a

2.

- a. However, luck and timing also play a significant role.
- b. Success is generally believed to require immense hard work.
- c. Ultimately, it is the combination of preparation and opportunity.
- d. Many highly successful individuals emphasize their early morning routines.

A. b d a c

B. b a d c

C. d b a c

D. c b a d

3.

- a. Next, you must draft your ideas into full paragraphs.
- b. Finally, proofreading ensures your work is free of errors.
- c. Writing a good essay involves several key steps.
- d. First, you should outline your main points clearly.

A. c d a b

B. c a d b

C. d a b c

D. c d b a

SECTION TWO: Jumbled Words (4-6)

Directions: Put the following words in the correct order to make a proper sentence.

4. time / will / get / unless / note / doctor's / you / a / off / not

- A. Unless you get a doctor's note time off you will not.
- B. You will not get time off unless you have a doctor's note.
- C. A doctor's note you will not get unless time off.
- D. You will not get a doctor's note unless time off you have.

5. friends / prefer / surrounded / some / people / being / their / by

- A. Some people prefer being surrounded by their friends.
- B. Being surrounded by their friends prefer some people.
- C. Some friends prefer being surrounded by their people.
- D. People prefer being some friends surrounded by their.

6. summer / away / moved / family / in / his / he / from

- A. In his family he moved away from summer.
- B. He moved away from his family in summer.
- C. From his family in summer he moved away.
- D. He in summer away from his family moved.

SECTION THREE: Letter Writing (7-9)

7. In a formal or semi-formal letter, the phrase "Best regards," is used as the:

- A. Salutation
- B. Body paragraph
- C. Closing
- D. Sender's address

8. The address of the person to whom we are writing the letter is known as the:

- A. Sender's address
- B. Receiver's address
- C. Salutation
- D. Reference line

9. "The young man glanced behind him, his heart pounding in his chest as he sprinted into the dark alley, desperately trying to run away from the police." This type of writing is most likely:

- A. Descriptive
- B. Argumentative
- C. Narrative
- D. Expository

SECTION FOUR: Punctuation and Capitalization (10-13)

10. Which one of the following sentences is correctly punctuated?

- A. "I cannot believe it!" she shouted.
- B. "I cannot believe it" she shouted!
- C. "I cannot believe it," she shouted!
- D. "I cannot believe it"! she shouted.

11. Which one of the following has correct capitalization?

- A. My uncle speaks English, french, and Amharic.
- B. My uncle speaks english, French, and Amharic.
- C. My uncle speaks English, French, and Amharic.
- D. my uncle speaks English, French, and amharic.

12. Which sentence is correctly punctuated?

- A. Addis Ababa the capital of Ethiopia is growing fast.
- B. Addis Ababa, the capital of Ethiopia, is growing fast.
- C. Addis Ababa the capital of Ethiopia, is growing fast.
- D. Addis Ababa, the capital of Ethiopia is growing fast.

13. Choose the correctly punctuated sentence.

- A. We need to buy: milk, bread and sugar.
- B. We need to buy milk, bread, and sugar.
- C. We need to buy; milk, bread and sugar.
- D. We need to buy milk bread and, sugar.

SECTION FIVE: Spelling (14-15)

14. Which of the following words is correctly spelled?

- A. procrastinate
- B. procastinate
- C. procrastinet
- D. procrastenate

15. Which of the following words is correctly spelled?

- A. spectaculer
- B. spectecular
- C. spectacular
- D. spectacular

SECTION SIX: Paragraph Type (16-17)

16. "She was a tall, blonde girl with careless hair that blew wildly in the wind, and her bright blue eyes sparkled under the afternoon sun." What kind of paragraph is this?

- A. Narrative
- B. Descriptive
- C. Argumentative
- D. Expository

17. "Teachers should take more responsibility for shaping the moral character of their students, as they spend a majority of their waking hours in the classroom." This sentence is most likely taken from an _____ essay.

- A. Argumentative
- B. Descriptive
- C. Narrative
- D. Instructional

II. Language Focus (18-50).

Directions: Choose the word or phrase that best completes the sentence.

18. After the accident, he suffered _____ severe back pain for months.

- A. with
- B. from
- C. of
- D. by

19. In summer, she usually moves away _____ her family to attend a special camp.

- A. from
- B. of
- C. in
- D. at

20. Extroverts typically prefer being surrounded _____ their friends.

- A. with
- B. by
- C. around
- D. among

21. The committee _____ seven experienced members.

- A. consists in
- B. consists of
- C. consists with
- D. consists from

22. If she had studied harder, she _____ the exam.

- A. would pass
- B. will pass
- C. would have passed
- D. passed

23. If you mix red and yellow, you _____ orange. (Zero Conditional)

- A. will get
- B. would get
- C. get
- D. got

24. If it rains tomorrow, we _____ the picnic.

- A. would cancel
- B. will cancel
- C. canceled
- D. cancel

25. "Do you clean your room?" my mother asked. My mother asked me if I _____ my room.

- A. clean
- B. cleaned
- C. was cleaning
- D. had cleaned

26. "I will call you later," he said. He said that he _____ call me later.

- A. will
- B. would
- C. can
- D. shall

27. I am so short. I wish I _____ taller.

- A. am
- B. was
- C. were
- D. had been

28. The manager decided to delay _____ the new software until next month.

- A. launch
- B. launching
- C. to launch
- D. launched

29. Despite the challenges, she really wants _____ her degree this year.

- A. finish
- B. finishing
- C. to finish
- D. finished

30. The manager, along with his assistants, _____ attending the conference right now.

- A. is
- B. are
- C. were
- D. have been

31. We need to buy more fruits, _____ some vegetables for the salad.

- A. as well as
- B. also
- C. in addition
- D. beside

32. Due to the economic crisis, the company had to lay _____ fifty workers.

- A. out
- B. down
- C. off
- D. over

33. Neither the students nor the teacher _____ aware of the sudden schedule change.

- A. was
- B. were
- C. are
- D. have been

34. By the time the police arrived, the thief _____ away.

- A. ran
- B. runs
- C. has run
- D. had run

35. The book _____ I borrowed from the library is very interesting.

- A. who
- B. whom
- C. whose
- D. which

36. I am looking forward _____ you soon.

- A. to see
- B. seeing
- C. to seeing
- D. see

37. They are used to _____ up early in the morning.

- A. wake
- B. waking
- C. woke
- D. waken

38. _____ he was tired, he finished his assignment.

- A. Because
- B. Although
- C. However
- D. Since

39. I would rather you _____ home now; it is getting dark.

- A. go
- B. went
- C. going
- D. gone

40. Selam is _____ intelligent that she easily solved the puzzle.

- A. such
- B. too
- C. so
- D. very

41. He asked me where _____ going.

- A. was I
- B. I was
- C. am I
- D. I am

42. The house _____ last year by a famous architect.

- A. builds
- B. built
- C. was built
- D. has built

43. You had better _____ an umbrella. It looks like it will rain.

- A. take
- B. to take
- C. taking
- D. took

44. _____ of the heavy rain, the football match was postponed.

- A. Because
- B. In spite
- C. Due to the fact
- D. Because of

45. Scarcely had she finished the exam _____ the bell rang.

- A. than
- B. when
- C. then
- D. while

46. She has been living in Addis Ababa _____ 2015.

- A. for
- B. since
- C. in
- D. from

47. I didn't mean to offend you; I just wanted to point _____ the error.

- A. in
- B. up
- C. out
- D. on

48. Could you please turn _____ the lights before leaving the room?

- A. off
- B. out
- C. down
- D. up

49. The teacher made the students _____ the exercise again.

- A. to do
- B. doing
- C. do
- D. did

50. If he _____ the truth, I wouldn't be angry now. (Mixed conditional context)

- A. tells
- B. told
- C. has told
- D. had told

III. Communicative Activities (51-65)

Directions: Choose the alternative that is most appropriate to complete the dialogue.

51. Aster: Do you prefer reading books or watching movies?

Bilen: _____

- A. I prefer read books.
- B. I'd rather watching movies.
- C. I prefer reading books to watching movies.
- D. I like better movies than books.

52. Teacher: Global warming is the most serious current issue we face today.

Student: _____. The climate changes are visible everywhere.

- A. I totally agree with you
- B. I don't think so
- C. That makes no sense
- D. I completely disagree

53. Friend: I finally got the scholarship to study abroad!

You: _____

- A. Oh no, I am so sorry for your grief.
- B. That's wonderful! I am so happy for you!
- C. Why did you do that?
- D. I disagree with your choice.

54. Sister: My pet dog just passed away last night.

Brother: _____

- A. Congratulations!
- B. I prefer cats anyway.
- C. Oh, I am so sorry to hear that. My deepest condolences.
- D. That's a great current issue.

55. John: I believe social media does more harm than good to teenagers.

Sara: _____. It helps them connect with peers globally.

- A. I couldn't agree more
- B. I completely disagree
- C. You are absolutely right
- D. No doubt about it

56. Waiter: Are you ready to order, sir?

Customer: _____

A. Yes, I will have the roasted chicken, please.

B. Yes, the kitchen is big.

C. No, I prefer eating out.

D. I bought this shirt yesterday.

57. Receptionist: Good morning, how can I help you?

Guest: _____

A. I'd like to book a room for two nights.

B. Yes, you can help me tomorrow.

C. I don't know your name.

D. The weather is nice.

58. Stranger: Excuse me, could you tell me where the nearest bank is?

You: _____

A. Yes, I need some money.

B. Go straight and turn left at the corner.

C. The bank is closed yesterday.

D. I agree with you.

59. Manager: Why were you late for the meeting?

Employee: _____

A. Because I prefer meetings in the morning.

B. I'm sorry, my car broke down on the way.

C. Yes, the meeting was very productive.

D. I am happy you asked.

60. Ali: Would you mind opening the window?

Beti: _____

A. Yes, please open it.

B. No, not at all. I'll open it right away.

C. I agree with you completely.

D. Yes, I mind opening the door.

61. Mother: Don't forget to wash your hands before dinner.

Son: _____

- A. I already did, mom.
- B. I don't like dinner.
- C. My hands are not in the kitchen.
- D. I prefer breakfast.

62. Shopkeeper: _____

Customer: I am just browsing, thank you.

- A. Can I help you find something?
- B. Do you want to leave?
- C. Are you buying or not?
- D. What is your name?

63. Patient: Doctor, I have been suffering from a severe headache for two days.

Doctor: _____

- A. I prefer headaches to stomachaches.
- B. Take this medicine and get some rest.
- C. You should go to a restaurant.
- D. I completely disagree.

64. Passenger: How long does the flight to Nairobi take?

Flight Attendant: _____

- A. It takes about two hours.
- B. Nairobi is a beautiful city.
- C. I am flying there too.
- D. The flight is delayed.

65. Interviewer: What do you consider to be your greatest strength?

Candidate: _____

- A. I am very bad at teamwork.
- B. I consider myself a very dedicated and hard-working person.
- C. I don't know anything about this job.
- D. My strength is not important.

IV. Comprehension (66-85)

SECTION ONE: Sentence Comprehension (66-68)

Directions: Choose the sentence with the closest meaning to the head sentence.

66. "You will not receive your pension unless you give a written notice prior to your retirement."
- A. A written notice is mandatory before retiring in order to get your pension.
 - B. You can get your pension without a written notice if you retire early.
 - C. Written notices are only for those who do not want a pension after retirement.
 - D. Retirement is delayed until you receive a pension notice.
67. "When I was younger, I should not have taken my education for granted." (Regression/Regret)
- A. I am proud of how I handled my education when I was young.
 - B. I regret that I did not value my education properly in my youth.
 - C. My education was granted to me when I was young.
 - D. I did not have any education when I was younger.
68. "You will not get time off work unless you present a valid doctor's note."
- A. A doctor's note guarantees you will be fired from work.
 - B. You can take time off without seeing a doctor.
 - C. Presenting a doctor's note is a necessary condition for getting time off.
 - D. Doctors are not allowed to give notes for time off work.

SECTION TWO: Reading Comprehension (69-85)

Directions: Read the passages carefully and answer the questions based on the information therein.

Passage 1: The Importance of Mental Health

(1) Mental health is a crucial component of overall well-being, yet it is frequently neglected in modern society. While physical health issues are easily identified and treated, mental health struggles often remain hidden due to societal stigma. Many individuals suffer in silence, believing that acknowledging their emotional or psychological pain is a sign of weakness. However, mental health is just as important as physical health, and neglecting it can severely impact a person's quality of life, relationships, and professional success.

(2) Various factors can negatively affect one's psychological well-being. Chronic stress from work, unresolved childhood trauma, and unhealthy relationships are known to **aggravate** underlying mental health conditions. Furthermore, in today's fast-paced digital world, excessive use of social media often leads to feelings of inadequacy and isolation. When these issues are left unaddressed, **they** can escalate into severe

anxiety disorders or clinical depression, making everyday tasks feel insurmountable.

(3) Addressing mental health requires a proactive approach. Regular exercise, a balanced diet, and sufficient sleep form a strong foundation for emotional resilience. Additionally, engaging in mindfulness practices such as meditation can help manage stress. However, self-care is sometimes not enough. When individuals feel overwhelmed, it is vital to seek professional support. **Ultimately**, consulting therapists or counselors is the most effective way to navigate deep-rooted psychological challenges and achieve long-term mental stability.

69. What is the central theme of Passage 1?

- A. The benefits of social media on relationships.
- B. The physical health challenges of the modern world.
- C. The importance of recognizing and addressing mental health.
- D. How to become a professional therapist.

70. According to paragraph 1, why do many individuals hide their mental health struggles?

- A. They enjoy suffering in silence.
- B. They believe physical health is less important.
- C. They fear the societal stigma and being seen as weak.
- D. They cannot afford medical treatment.

71. In paragraph 2, the word **aggravate** most likely means:

- A. To improve or heal.
- B. To make a problem worse or more severe.
- C. To completely ignore.
- D. To diagnose quickly.

72. In paragraph 2, the pronoun "**they**" refers to:

- A. Social media platforms.
- B. Individuals.
- C. These issues (factors affecting mental health).
- D. Childhood traumas.

73. According to the passage, what effect does excessive social media use have on individuals?
- A. It builds strong emotional resilience.
 - B. It leads to feelings of isolation and inadequacy.
 - C. It helps cure clinical depression.
 - D. It replaces the need for professional therapy.
74. What can be inferred from the passage about the relationship between physical and mental health?
- A. Physical health is much easier to diagnose and treat than mental health.
 - B. Mental health is dependent solely on physical exercises.
 - C. Physical health is entirely unrelated to emotional well-being.
 - D. Only doctors can treat physical health, but anyone can treat mental health.
75. In paragraph 3, the word **Ultimately** most closely means:
- A. In the beginning.
 - B. Partially.
 - C. In the end; fundamentally.
 - D. Rarely.
76. According to paragraph 3, what is suggested when self-care methods are not enough?
- A. To sleep more often.
 - B. To quit one's job to avoid stress.
 - C. To seek professional support from therapists.
 - D. To delete all social media accounts immediately.
77. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a foundational practice for emotional resilience?
- A. Regular exercise
 - B. Sufficient sleep
 - C. Taking strong medication
 - D. A balanced diet

Passage 2: The Value of Soft Skills

(1) In the modern workforce, the criteria for hiring have shifted significantly. Traditionally, employers placed a heavy emphasis on "hard skills"—the specific, teachable abilities and technical knowledge required to perform a job. For example, programming, accounting, and fluency in a foreign language are considered hard skills. While these abilities remain essential, extensive researches show that they are no longer sufficient on

their own to guarantee career success in today's highly collaborative work environments.

(2) Enter "soft skills," which refer to interpersonal attributes, communication abilities, and personality traits that dictate how individuals interact with others. Soft skills include emotional intelligence, teamwork, adaptability, and problem-solving. Unlike hard skills, which are specific to a particular profession, soft skills are highly transferable across different industries. A software engineer, for instance, needs the hard skill of coding, but **it** is their soft skills that allow them to effectively communicate their progress to their team and adapt to sudden changes in a project.

(3) When comparing the two, many human resource experts argue that soft skills are actually more valuable for long-term growth in the current corporate world. An employee lacking a specific technical skill can easily be trained or sent to a workshop. However, it is much more difficult to teach an arrogant employee how to be empathetic, or to train a stubborn worker to embrace teamwork. As automation and artificial intelligence take over routine technical tasks, human-centric soft skills are becoming the defining factor that separates outstanding employees from average ones.

78. What is the main purpose of Passage 2?

- A. To explain why hard skills are completely obsolete.
- B. To compare hard skills and soft skills, highlighting the growing importance of soft skills.
- C. To teach readers how to write a computer program.
- D. To argue that artificial intelligence will replace all human workers.

79. Which of the following is an example of a hard skill according to the passage?

- A. Teamwork
- B. Emotional intelligence
- C. Accounting
- D. Adaptability

80. In paragraph 2, the pronoun "**it**" refers to:

- A. The hard skill of coding.
- B. A software engineer.
- C. Their soft skills.
- D. A particular profession.

81. Why do human resource experts consider soft skills more valuable for long-term growth?
- A. Soft skills are much cheaper to learn than hard skills.
 - B. Soft skills are harder to teach to an employee than technical skills.
 - C. Artificial intelligence possesses high soft skills.
 - D. Hard skills cannot be transferred to different industries.
82. Based on the passage, what is the impact of artificial intelligence on the workforce?
- A. It makes human-centric soft skills more highly valued.
 - B. It performs all the interpersonal communication for employees.
 - C. It eliminates the need for problem-solving skills.
 - D. It teaches hard skills to stubborn workers.
83. Which word in paragraph 2 means "capable of being moved from one place/job to another"?
- A. Interpersonal
 - B. Transferable
 - C. Collaborative
 - D. Specific
84. What can be inferred about an employee with excellent hard skills but poor soft skills?
- A. They will easily become the CEO of the company.
 - B. They might struggle to work effectively in a team environment.
 - C. They will definitely be replaced by artificial intelligence tomorrow.
 - D. They are highly adaptable to sudden project changes.
85. How do hard skills differ from soft skills based on paragraph 2?
- A. Hard skills dictate how we interact with others, while soft skills do not.
 - B. Hard skills are generally specific to a profession, while soft skills apply across industries.
 - C. Hard skills involve emotional intelligence, whereas soft skills involve coding.
 - D. There is no actual difference between the two in the modern workforce.

V. Vocabulary (86-100)

SECTION ONE: Sentence Completion (86-93)

Directions: Choose the word or phrase that best completes the sentences.

86. He is regarded as a respected expert in _____ economy.

- A. the
- B. a
- C. an
- D. no article

87. The university offers scholarships for mathematics _____ physics students.

- A. as well as
- B. in spite of
- C. however
- D. because of

88. The committee decided to _____ her for the prestigious award because of her excellent performance.

- A. terminate
- B. nominate
- C. suspend
- D. aggravate

89. The lawyer presented _____ evidence that completely changed the outcome of the trial.

- A. trivial
- B. substantive
- C. weak
- D. irrelevant

90. Because of the sharp drop in sales, the factory had to _____ a large number of employees.

- A. lay off
- B. put off
- C. take over
- D. bring up

91. The new diet plan _____ mostly of fresh vegetables, lean proteins, and whole grains.

- A. consists
- B. contains
- C. involves
- D. comprises

92. Instead of a strong excuse, he gave a very _____ reason for his absence, so nobody believed him.

- A. convincing
- B. unbelievable
- C. genuine
- D. true

93. We must work hard to _____ our ultimate goals this year.

- A. destroy
- B. forget
- C. achieve
- D. ignore

SECTION TWO: Word Substitution (94-98)

Directions: Choose one word or phrase that keeps the meaning of the given sentence if substituted for the underlined word.

94. The old building was demolished to make way for a new shopping mall.

- A. repaired
- B. constructed
- C. pulled down
- D. painted

95. You should look into the matter before making a final decision.

- A. investigate
- B. ignore
- C. forget
- D. hide

96. Her continuous complaints began to annoy everyone in the office.

- A. please
- B. irritate
- C. entertain
- D. assist

97. The disease is highly contagious, so the patient must be isolated.

- A. curable
- B. harmless
- C. infectious
- D. rare

98. The students were asked to hand in their exam papers when the bell rang.

- A. distribute
- B. submit
- C. tear up
- D. hide

SECTION THREE: Antonyms (99-100)

Directions: Choose the word that is most nearly OPPOSITE in meaning to the underlined word.

99. The government's new educational policy was heavily criticized for being too rigid.

- A. strict
- B. flexible
- C. complicated
- D. expensive

100. The speaker's explanation of the scientific topic was very obscure, leaving the audience entirely confused.

- A. clear
- B. hidden
- C. dark
- D. vague

THE END

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ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATIONS

Section I: Writing (1-17)

1. **A (a c d b)** - Starts with the general definition (a), gives types (c), provides an example (d), and concludes (b).
2. **B (b a d c)** - Introduces success and hard work (b), contrasts with luck (a), gives an example of hard work/routines (d), and concludes (c).
3. **C (c d a b)** - Topic sentence (c), first step (d), next step (a), final step (b).
4. **B** - "You will not get time off unless you have a doctor's note." (Proper conditional sentence structure).
5. **A** - "Some people prefer being surrounded by their friends."
6. **B** - "He moved away from his family in summer."
7. **C** - "Best regards" is a complimentary close/closing.
8. **B** - The person receiving it is the receiver, hence the receiver's address.
9. **C** - It tells a story with action (running away), which is Narrative.
10. **C** - "I cannot believe it," she shouted! (Comma separates the quote from the dialogue tag properly).
11. **C** - Languages (English, French, Amharic) must all be capitalized.
12. **B** - "the capital of Ethiopia" is an appositive and needs commas on both sides.
13. **B** - Items in a series are separated by commas (milk, bread, and sugar).
14. **A** - "procrastinate" is the correct spelling.
15. **C** - "spectacular" is the correct spelling.
16. **B** - Descriptive; it uses adjectives (tall, blonde, careless, bright blue) to paint a picture.
17. **A** - Argumentative; it presents a claim ("Teachers should take more responsibility") with a supporting reason.

Section II: Language Focus (18-50)

18. **B** - Suffer is followed by the preposition "from".
19. **A** - Move away "from".
20. **B** - Surrounded "by".
21. **B** - Consist takes the preposition "of".
22. **C** - Type 3 conditional: If + past perfect (had studied), would have + past participle (would have passed).
23. **C** - Zero conditional for facts: If + present simple, present simple.
24. **B** - Type 1 conditional: If + present simple (rains), will + base verb (will cancel).
25. **B** - Reported speech: present simple ("Do you clean") changes to past simple ("cleaned").
26. **B** - Reported speech: "will" changes to "would".
27. **C** - Wish for present unreality uses the past tense (were). "I wish I were taller."
28. **B** - The verb "delay" is followed by a gerund (-ing form).
29. **C** - The verb "want" is followed by an infinitive (to + verb).
30. **A** - "The manager" is singular. Phrases like "along with" do not make the subject plural.
31. **A** - "as well as" fits grammatically to add items to a list in this context.
32. **C** - "lay off" means to fire or dismiss employees.
33. **A** - With "Neither... nor", the verb agrees with the closest noun ("the teacher", which is singular).
34. **D** - Past perfect (had run) is used for an action that happened before another action in the past (police arrived).
35. **D** - "which" is the relative pronoun used for things (the book).
36. **C** - "look forward to" is followed by a gerund (-ing).
37. **B** - "used to" (meaning accustomed to) is followed by a gerund (-ing) when preceded by the 'be' verb (are).
38. **B** - "Although" shows contrast.
39. **B** - "would rather" followed by a subject (you) takes the past tense (went) for present/future meaning.
40. **C** - "so + adjective + that".

41. **B** - Embedded questions use statement word order (subject + verb: I was).
42. **C** - Passive voice in the past tense (was built).
43. **A** - "had better" is followed by the bare infinitive (take).
44. **D** - "Because of" is a preposition followed by a noun phrase (the heavy rain).
45. **B** - "Scarcely... when" is the correct correlative conjunction pairing.
46. **B** - "since" is used with a specific starting point in time (2015).
47. **C** - "point out" means to draw attention to something.
48. **A** - "turn off" is used for lights.
49. **C** - "make" (when active) takes the bare infinitive (do).
50. **D** - Mixed conditional: Past unreality (had told) affecting a present result (wouldn't be angry now).

Section III: Communicative Activities (51-65)

51. **C** - Proper structure for preference: "prefer [noun/gerund] to [noun/gerund]".
52. **A** - The student adds supporting evidence ("visible everywhere"), so they agree.
53. **B** - A positive response to good news.
54. **C** - Expressing grief/condolence.
55. **B** - Sara provides a positive point ("helps them connect"), so she disagrees with John's negative view.
56. **A** - Logical response to a waiter taking an order.
57. **A** - Logical request at a hotel reception.
58. **B** - Giving directions.
59. **B** - Giving a reason for being late.
60. **B** - Answering a "Would you mind" question politely.
61. **A** - Appropriate response to a reminder.
62. **A** - A shopkeeper offering assistance.
63. **B** - A doctor giving advice/prescription.

64. A - Giving information about flight duration.

65. B - Answering a standard interview question.

Section IV: Comprehension (66-85)

66. A - Rephrases "unless you give written notice" to "mandatory before retiring".

67. B - The speaker wishes they had done things differently (regression/regret).

68. C - The doctor's note is mandatory for the time off.

69. C - The passage focuses on recognizing mental health issues and seeking help.

70. C - Explicitly stated in paragraph 1 ("due to societal stigma... sign of weakness").

71. B - "Aggravate" means to make a problem worse.

72. C - "They" refers to the issues/factors mentioned previously.

73. B - Stated in paragraph 2 ("feelings of inadequacy and isolation").

74. A - Inferred from paragraph 1 ("physical health issues are easily identified... mental health struggles often remain hidden").

75. C - "Ultimately" means in the end or fundamentally.

76. C - Stated in paragraph 3 ("vital to seek professional support").

77. C - Medication is not mentioned; exercise, sleep, and diet are.

78. B - Compares both but emphasizes the growing value of soft skills.

79. C - Accounting is listed as a specific technical/hard skill.

80. C - "it is their soft skills that allow them..."

81. B - Paragraph 3 states technical skills are easy to train, but traits like empathy or teamwork are hard to teach.

82. A - As AI takes over routine tasks, human soft skills separate great employees from average ones.

83. B - Transferable.

84. B - They lack interpersonal skills like teamwork.

85. B - Hard skills are profession-specific, whereas soft skills are transferable across industries.

Section V: Vocabulary (86-100)

86. A - "the economy" refers to a specific system, requiring the definite article.
87. A - "as well as" acts similarly to 'and'.
88. B - "nominate" means to propose someone for an award or position.
89. B - "substantive" means having a firm basis in reality; important or meaningful.
90. A - "lay off" means to terminate employment due to economic reasons.
91. A - "consists" is followed by "of".
92. B - "unbelievable" fits because nobody believed the reason given.
93. C - "achieve" means to successfully bring about or reach a desired objective or result.
94. C - "pulled down" is a synonym for demolished.
95. A - "look into" is a phrasal verb meaning to investigate.
96. B - "annoy" means to irritate.
97. C - "contagious" means infectious (can be spread from one to another).
98. B - "hand in" means to submit.
99. B - "flexible" is the opposite of rigid.
100. A - "clear" is the opposite of obscure (which means unclear or hard to understand).